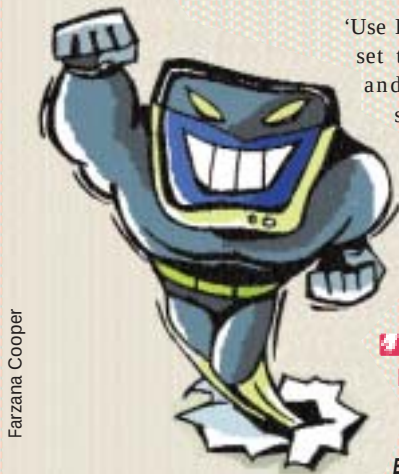


MAYA

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Farzana Cooper

‘Use Default Button’ option, set the Project as Current and save your working scenes. Transfer all file textures to the Source Image folder. Before you render, delete all unused nodes. To do this, go to **File > Optimize Scene Size**.

Clean the Channel box

Select Object and then go to **Window > General Editor > Channel Control**. Select channels that you won’t use on your current object. Click on Move to transfer them to the Non Keyable attributes. Also, look out for Non Keyable attributes such as Shear, Ghosting, etc.—you can transfer them to the Keyable attributes with the Move button.

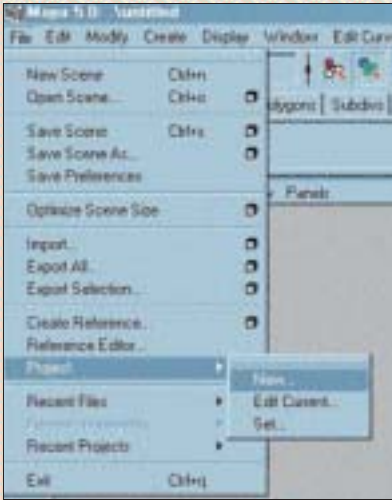
You can split an outliner in two to efficiently manage a number of objects. Click on the grey line at the bottom of the outliner and drag it upwards to do so.

Lock the camera To the right in the channel box, select the channels by name, click on the one on top, drag it to the last, right-click and select Lock Selected.

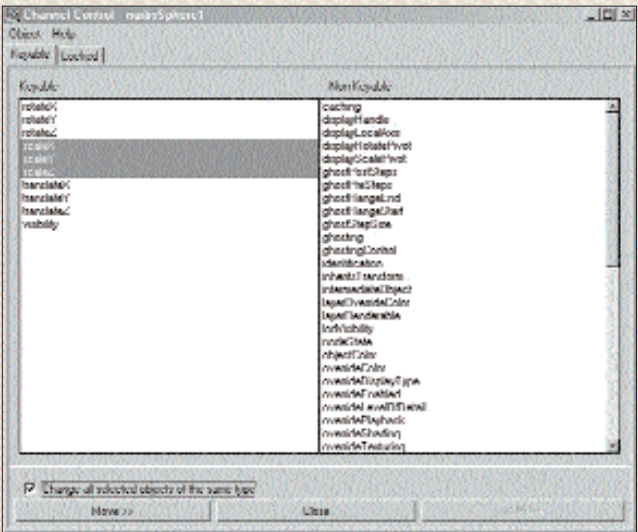
General user tips

Manage your scenes

A project lets you group different files such as rendered images, needed for a scene or a group of related scenes. Go to Create Project and click the



Group different files needed for a scene into a Project



Transfer unused channels into the NonKeyable attributes

To revert to selections

Go to **Create > Sets > Quick Selection Sets** and name the selection. Next, go to **Edit > Quick Select Set**. This is handy when you have to revert to selected vertices in a complex mesh. Use the Lasso tool or go to **Edit > Paint Selection Tool**, to make Selections.

Modeling

Making polygonal Models

To keep a check on your polygonal count, Go to **Display > Heads Up Display > Poly Count On** to do so. Make a polygon smooth proxy by going to **Polygon > Smooth Proxy**. For symmetrical characters or models, model only one half, and when complete, mirror the other half. Do this by going to **Polygon > Mirror Geometry**. Here, choose the respective axis and select Mirror. You can also opt to ‘Merge the Vertices’ at this

time. Rig this LowPoly model, and keep checking the skinning results, the Outputs on the hiRes model, or the Smooth Proxy. Keeping the LowPoly and HiPoly on two



Use the sel box to name the selection

different layers is usually helpful, for files with large scenes, and also when you have to edit vertices—the fewer the better.

To make wires, tails for polygonal meshes

To create creatures, pipes, or get multiple appendages to protrude quickly, use the extrude process. To do this, select the edges or faces you want to extrude and the curve you want to extrude along. Go to **Edit Polygons > Extrude Face or Edit Polygons > Extrude Edge**. Here, turn on the



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